INFORMED CONSENT FORM FOR RESEARCH PARTICIPATION

Department of Computer Science and Engineering, Shahjalal University of Science and Technology (SUST), Sylhet

1. Project Information

Research Title: An End-to-End Speech-to-Speech Framework for Expressive Bengali Accent Conversion using a Novel Parallel Corpus

Research Team: Arfatul Islam Asif (Student Researcher), Unayes Ahmed Khan (Student Researcher)

Supervisor: Professor Mohammad Shahidur Rahman, PhD

2. Purpose of the Study

You are invited to participate in a research study dedicated to developing technology that can convert regional Bengali accents into Standard Bengali while preserving the speaker's original voice. The primary goal is to build the **Bengali Parallel Accent Corpus (BPAC)**, a dataset used to train Artificial Intelligence models to understand and normalize different Bengali dialects (e.g., Sylheti, Chittagonian, Noakhali).

3. Procedures

If you agree to participate, you will be asked to:

1. Attend a recording session in a controlled laboratory setting.
2. Read a specific set of Standard Bengali scripts/sentences aloud.
3. Allow your voice to be recorded using professional audio equipment.

4. Data Usage and Open Source Release

This research aims to contribute to the scientific community. Therefore, the data collected will be processed as follows:

- **Public Data (Open Source):** Your voice recordings, along with your **District (Region)**, **Gender**, and **Age**, will be made publicly available as an open-source dataset for research purposes. This allows other researchers to improve Bengali speech technology.
- **Private Data (Confidential):** Your **Name**, **Full Address**, **Phone Number**, and any other direct contact information will **NEVER** be published or shared publicly. This information is strictly for administrative use by the research team.

5. Voluntary Participation

Participation in this study is completely voluntary. You are free to withdraw your consent before publication of this study.

6. Compensation

7. Contact Information

If you have any questions or concerns about this study, please contact the researchers at:

- **Department of CSE, SUST**
- **Email:** arfatulislam2001@gmail.com (Arfatul Islam Asif), unayeskhan.0808@gmail.com (Unayes Ahmed Khan)

8. Participant Declaration

I have read the information provided above (or it has been read to me). I understand that my voice recordings and specific demographic data (Age, Gender, District) will be made publicly available for research purposes, while my personal identity (Name, Contact Information) will remain confidential. I agree to participate in this study.

Participant's Full Name: _____

Age: _____ **Gender:** _____ **District:** _____

Participant Signature: _____ **Date:** _____